

ALL COMPUTERS GREAT AND SMALL



Personal Tech Support with Heart

All Computers Great and Small was created to help people feel confident—not overwhelmed—by technology. After a lifetime of learning, teaching, and

troubleshooting computers, I saw how often people are expected to *use* technology without ever being shown how it works. That gap is where I come in.

I created the **“Get a Ride to Get Around”** guide for the same reason I started my business: independence matters. As more everyday tasks—like transportation, appointments, and staying connected—move to phones and apps, it can feel daunting. This guide is meant to reduce that anxiety and show that learning new tools can be practical, manageable, and empowering.

I offer personalized, in-home tech support tailored to you: your devices, your comfort level, and your goals. Whether you’re learning a smartphone, practicing how to request a ride, organizing years of photos, or exploring how technology can support aging in place, I act as a patient translator between you and the digital world. My goal is simple: to make technology accessible, understandable, and even enjoyable.

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Round Round, Get Around...

How to Get a Ride to Get Around

This How-To gives step-by-step instructions for Uber as well as alternatives including GoGoGrandparent and Lyft Silver.



Rideshare services

Uber, Lyft and GoGoGrandparent are ride services you can use instead of a taxi. You request a ride using an app on your cell phone or by placing a phone call, and a driver picks you up and takes you to your destination.

You may see these called “rideshare” services, but rides are private, not shared with other passengers, unless you specifically request to share the ride, and the cost, with others. For the sake of simplicity, and the purposes of this How-To, we’ll assume that you’ll be booking a private ride.



The most widely used rideshare service. You request a ride in an app, see your driver and car details and pay automatically with a credit card that you'll add to the app beforehand.



Very similar to Uber. Lyft gives the option of using Lyft Silver, a simplified version of Lyft designed for older adults, with larger text, fewer choices, and more patient drivers.



Lets you request Uber or Lyft rides by phone, without a smartphone or app. A live operator can help, but rides cost slightly more. This is a pre-booked "ride service" so the driver can only drop you off at the address initially indicated with no steps in between.

If you are comfortable with a smartphone, Uber or Lyft Silver are best.

If you prefer speaking to a live person, GoGoGrandparent is the easiest option.



The RIDE (MBTA)

☎ 617-337-2727



The RIDE is a door-to-door transportation service for people with a doctor-certified disability that makes public transportation difficult.

- Available **365 days a year**
- Serves the North Shore & Greater Boston
- Can be used for **any purpose**, not just medical

Visit the MBTA website for eligibility and applications:

<https://www.mbta.com/accessibility/the-ride>



Seaglass Village

☎ 781-718-0401

Seaglass Village members may request rides from volunteers:

- Call Seaglass to inquire about becoming a full member. Once you are a full member, you can request rides.
- Rides should be requested at least 3 days in advance
- A volunteer will contact you to confirm details

LOCAL RIDE RESOURCES

Both Marblehead and Swampscott Senior Centers offer van rides either by appointment (for medical visits) or on certain days to different stores.

Nahant Council on Aging suggests using the MBTA'S "The RIDE."

Swampscott Senior Center

☎ 781-596-8866

- Monday: Market Basket, Target, Shaw's, Swampscott Library & Town Hall
- Tuesday & Wednesday: Medical rides by appointment
- Thursday: Stop & Shop, Whole Foods, Vinnin Square
- 3rd Friday of each month: Walmart



Marblehead Senior Center

☎ 781-631-6225

- Tuesday: Marblehead Food Pantry
- Wednesday: Crosby's
- Thursday: Market Basket
- Medical rides: By appointment only



Many people, including myself, use Uber and Lyft regularly for everyday trips and travel. You may want help setting up the app at first, but once that's done, this How-To will guide you in booking rides confidently on your own.

What You Need to Get Started

- A smartphone, tablet, or computer
- An internet connection
- A credit or debit card (added once, stored securely)

Installing Uber or Lyft (they are free apps)

- iPhone: download from App Store → search Uber or Lyft
- Android or Jitterbug smartphone: Play Store → search Uber or Lyft
- Computer or tablet: go to uber.com or lyft.com

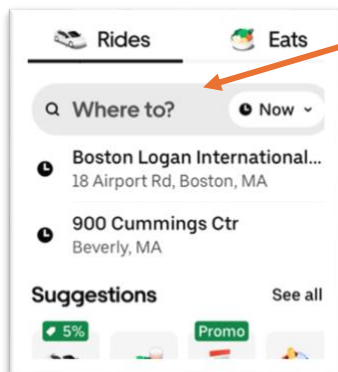
Setting Up Your Account

- Create an account using your phone number or email address
- Add a payment method
- Make sure notifications are turned ON (important for ride updates)

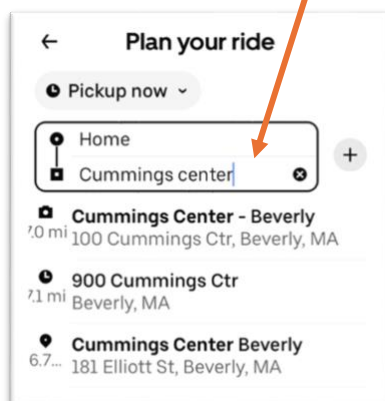


UBER INSTRUCTIONS

1. Open the Uber app and tap on "Where to?"



On the next screen, type your destination (an address or a location name, like Logan Airport or Cummings Center).



You'll see options appear, and when you see the **exact** destination, tap it.

2. Next, tap UberX (best option).
3. Confirm your pickup spot. This fills in automatically, so for simplicity, you'll want to do this when you are **at** your pickup location.
4. *NOTE: when you tap on "Confirm Pickup" you are confirming that you want the driver to pick you up immediately (e.g., within 10 minutes) so be sure you are ready to leave.*

Once confirmed, you'll see:

- The driver's name and photo
- The car make, model, and color
- The license plate number
- An estimated arrival time

Practice Makes Perfect

If you've had a cell phone for a while and feel comfortable using it to play games, browse the internet, or get directions, you will likely find *Uber* or *Lyft* easy to use as well. While Uber is more widely known, Lyft has made a strong effort to design its app to be especially user-friendly, regardless of age. Its **Lyft Silver** option makes the process even simpler.



Small steps help! If possible, ask someone to sit with you while you practice booking a ride a few times (being careful not to actually request a ride). After just a few practice runs, most people find they become comfortable surprisingly quickly.

If you're less comfortable using apps or prefer speaking with a live person, GoGoGrandparent is an excellent alternative. This service is designed specifically for people who do not use smartphones or who feel uneasy with technology. In this case, it's still important to have a cell phone with you and turned on before and during your ride.



If you'd like hands-on practice or have questions,

All Computers Great and Small offers free tech help:

- Marblehead Abbot Library — Tuesdays, 3–5 pm
- Swampscott Council on Aging — First and third Wednesdays of each month, 2–4 pm

The remainder of this guide provides additional information about local ride resources.

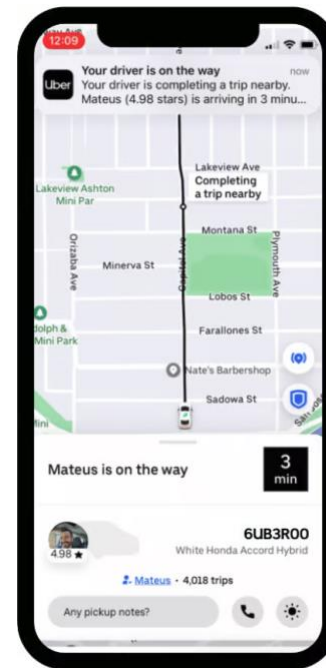
Use Uber or Lyft by phone, without ever needing to touch a computer! How it works:

- 📞 Call 1-855-464-6872
- Follow the instructions given. The options may change, so I will not present them here. You will be instructed to press a number depending on if you are a new rider or a registered rider.
- If new, you will need to sign up for a monthly or yearly plan. They have flexible monthly plans starting at \$16.99 a month.
- While a smartphone is not required, a cell phone is strongly encouraged so they can reach you or you can call them.
- A live operator is always available to help pressing 0.



Good to know

- Uses Uber/Lyft drivers
- They offer other services such as grocery or meal deliveries or pharmacy pickups
- 💰 Slightly higher cost due to concierge service
- Credit card is required (cash is not an option)
- Be aware of whether you are signing up for a monthly or yearly plan, and whether you will be billed up front or monthly.
- Make sure to *put their number in your cell phone* so that you will recognize their number when they call you, and so you can call them when necessary.



Safety Tips

- Match the car (color, make, model, license plate) as described in the app
- Match the driver photo
- Ask the driver: "Who are you here to pick up?" (They should say *your name*)

Trusted Contacts (Highly Recommended)

You can add Trusted Contacts in the Uber app.

They will receive notifications when your ride starts and be able to track your trip and estimated arrival time.

To add Trusted Contacts, tap the Account icon at bottom right corner of screen:



Then tap Settings. On the next screen, scroll down and tap "Manage Trusted Contacts". When prompted with "How do you want to share contacts?" tap on "Select Contacts". Tap the name of the person you want to add as a Trusted Contact. Tap on "Allow Selected Contact". Then tap their name one more time.

INSTRUCTIONS

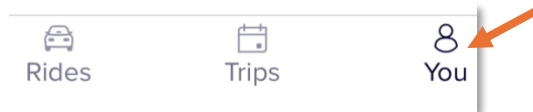
Lyft has a feature called Lyft Silver that is designed specifically for older adults.

Lyft Silver has:

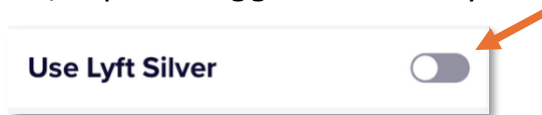
- Larger text and simpler screens
- Slower, clearer prompts
- Extra driver patience and assistance
- Priority access to experienced drivers



After you install Lyft on your phone, tap on the You icon at bottom right corner of screen:



Then, under Programs, tap on "Lyft Silver". On the next screen, tap the toggle for "Use Lyft Silver".

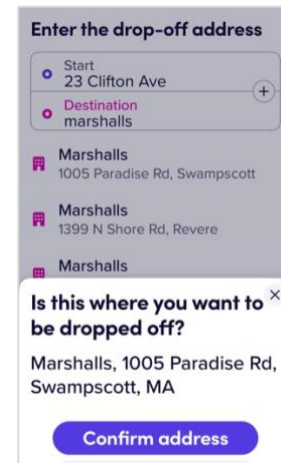
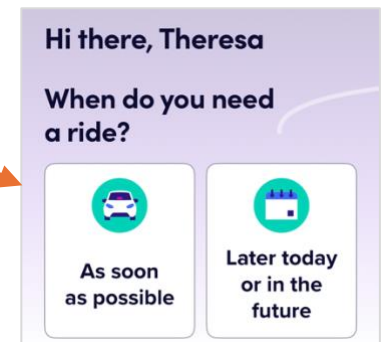


You'll be prompted with "Want to turn on Lyft Silver?" Tap "Yes, turn it on". When asked, it is recommended that you tap on "Allow calls" so that you get a phone call when your driver is arriving.

If you get another screen asking if you want to set up "Women+ Connect" you can go ahead and do that or just tap the x in the right corner of that screen.

Now, when you wish to book a ride:

1. You'll be asked to confirm when you want to be picked up.
2. Then, confirm where you want to be picked up. It defaults to your current location. For simplicity, you'll want to do this when you are ***at*** your pickup location.



3. Next, type in your destination. You can type an address or a location name, like Marshalls. Once you see your ***exact*** destination, tap on it, and confirm the address.
4. If you chose "Later today..." you'll be prompted to enter a date and time for the pickup.
5. Once you enter the date and time (or if you chose "As soon as possible") you'll be prompted to select a ride type. "*Silver Select*" is a few more dollars but provides cars that are easier to enter and exit as well as up to 7 minutes of wait time.
6. You must then confirm your pickup location one more time. Once you click "Confirm pickup", you'll be prompted to confirm the payment, and once you do, you will see your driver's details.